

FILM DOSSIER: X-MEN: AGE OF APOCALYPSE

Phase 6 · Film #5 (Saga Two, Film #24 · Overall Film #53)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	Saga Two #24 (Phase 6, Film #5) · MCU #53
Phase	Phase 6, The Secret Wars Saga : "Secret Wars"
Real title	<i>X-MEN: AGE OF APOCALYPSE</i> (the name of the 616 event)
Decoy / codename title	" <i>ALPHA OMEGA</i> "
Release date	Friday, November 2, 2029 . Marvel's fall slot
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Matthew Vaughn (returning from X-Men, 2011)
Rating / runtime	PG-13 (the hard end of it) · 172 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + dystopian war film / resistance epic

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	THE X-MEN ensemble (X-Men, film 3 of the franchise), led by Magneto (Ian McKellen) and Bishop (Omar Sy)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Magneto , leader of the X-Men	Ian McKellen (<i>digitally de-aged to his 50s, the precedent set for Samuel L. Jackson in Captain America</i>)	90
Lucas Bishop (<i>the man who remembers another world</i>)	Omar Sy (<i>played Bishop in X-Men: Days of Future Past, 2014</i>)	51
Rogue (<i>Magneto's wife</i>)	Anna Paquin (<i>the most iconic, longest-serving real Rogue</i>)	47
En Sabah Nur / Apocalypse	Oscar Isaac (<i>played Apocalypse in X-Men: Apocalypse, 2016; see the casting note</i>)	50
Weapon X (Logan)	Hugh Jackman	61
Jean Grey	Sophie Turner	33
Scott Summers / Cyclops (<i>one of Apocalypse's lieutenants</i>)	Tye Sheridan	32
Kurt Wagner / Nightcrawler	Kodi Smit-McPhee	33
Ororo Munroe / Storm	Alexandra Shipp	38
Piotr Rasputin / Colossus	Daniel Cudmore	48
Clarice Ferguson / Blink	Fan Bingbing (<i>played Blink in Days of Future Past</i>)	48
Victor Creed / Sabretooth (<i>an X-Man here</i>)	Liev Schreiber (<i>played Sabretooth in X-Men Origins: Wolverine, 2009</i>)	62
Hank McCoy / Dark Beast	Nicholas Hoult	39
Mister Sinister	Fresh casting (<i>never played by a real actor</i>)	–
David Haller / Legion (<i>the prologue</i>)	Dan Stevens (<i>played David Haller in Legion, 2017–19</i>)	47
Charles Xavier (<i>the prologue</i>)	Patrick Stewart (<i>digitally de-aged</i>)	89

Casting notes:

- **Oscar Isaac*** plays Apocalypse and Moon Knight, the same precedent as Laurence Fishburne and Brian Tyree Henry. The two never share a scene. **Apocalypse is a full prosthetic and performance-capture role.**
- Ian McKellen is locked as Magneto. **The Age of Apocalypse's Magneto is a man in his prime, so he's digitally de-aged (the SLJ precedent).** McKellen performs every dramatic scene*; *the action uses doubles and his de-aged face.*

*In memoriam: Stan Lee (1922–2018), who co-created the X-Men (X-Men #1, 1963). The X-Men's hidden base, Wundagore, has one wall of names of the dead. The first name is "Charles." The last line on it, by itself, reads "Excelsior."****

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	" <i>Age of Apocalypse</i> " (1995), Scott Lobdell, Mark Waid, Fabian Nicieza and others: <i>X-Men: Alpha</i> and <i>X-Men: Omega</i> plus <i>Astonishing X-Men</i> , <i>Amazing X-Men</i> , <i>Weapon X</i> , <i>Factor X</i> , <i>X-Calibre</i> , <i>Generation Next</i> , <i>Gambit and the X-Ternals</i> and <i>X-Man</i> #1–4. Legion travels back in time to kill Magneto, and kills his own father, Charles Xavier , instead. Apocalypse rises ten years early and conquers North America . Magneto founds the X-Men in Xavier's name, and marries Rogue . Bishop remembers a world where Xavier lived . He goes into the M'Kraan Crystal to undo this world . In the end Magneto tears Apocalypse in half . <i>Age of Apocalypse</i> #1–5 (2015), Fabian Nicieza & Gerardo Sandoval, the <i>Secret Wars</i> tie-in: the Age of Apocalypse is a domain of Battleworld .
Supporting comics	<i>X-Factor</i> #5–6 (1986, Apocalypse) · <i>Uncanny X-Men</i> #282–283 (1991, Bishop) · <i>Uncanny X-Men</i> #317 (1994, Blink)
Nerf check	☒ Apocalypse is ancient, near-immortal, shape-shifting and nearly limitless in strength . He rules a continent . Magneto , at full power, tears him in half (<i>X-Men: Omega</i>), as on the page.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	94% . The 1995 event is pressed into one film, with the Battleworld frame of the 2015 tie-in.

Straight from the page:

- **Legion kills Xavier** in the past (*X-Men: Alpha*).
- **Apocalypse conquers North America**; the **Human High Council** plans a **nuclear strike** (*Alpha, Omega*).
- **Magneto's X-Men: Rogue** (his wife), **Blink**, **Sabretooth**, **Nightcrawler**, **Colossus**, **Storm** (*Astonishing X-Men*, *X-Calibre*, *Amazing X-Men*).
- **Weapon X** and **Jean Grey** (*Weapon X*).
- **Cyclops serves Sinister**, and **turns** (*Factor X*).
- **Dark Beast** is **Apocalypse's scientist** (*Factor X*).
- **Bishop remembers** a world with Xavier (*Alpha*).
- **Bishop enters the M'Kraan Crystal** (*Omega*).
- **Magneto tears Apocalypse in half** (*Omega*).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| **Bishop's journey into the M'Kraan Crystal** doesn't reach a **past**. It shows him **that the domain's past** doesn't exist: **Battleworld is less than two years old**. | **On Battleworld, there's no real past to go back to**.

Bishop's discovery **cracks Doom's lie open.** |
| **Gambit and the X-Ternals are left out** | Runtime |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Apocalypse	Molecular control of his own body, immense strength, near-immortality, Celestial technology	All of it	–	✓ 100%
Magneto	Master of magnetism	Pulls the iron out of Apocalypse's body	–	✓ 100%
Bishop	Absorbs energy and fires it back	All of it	–	✓ 100%
Rogue	Absorbs powers and memories by touch	All of it	–	✓ 100%
Blink	Teleportation portals	All of it	–	✓ 100%
Weapon X	Healing factor, adamantium, one hand (Cyclops took the other)	All of it	–	✓ 100%
Jean Grey	Telepathy, telekinesis	All of it	The Phoenix (not in this story)	✓ 100%
Cyclops	Optic blasts, one eye (Logan took the other)	All of it	–	✓ 100%
Sabretooth	Healing factor; savage	All of it	–	✓ 100%
Storm / Colossus / Nightcrawler	As established	All of it	–	✓ 100%
Mister Sinister	Genetic genius, shape-shifting	All of it	–	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	In a world where Charles Xavier died before he founded the X-Men, Magneto leads them against Apocalypse, and one soldier who remembers a better world will find out his world was never real at all.
Theme	Legacy. Magneto became the man his friend wanted him to be, in a world that should never have existed.
Villain / antagonist	APOCALYPSE (main); Mister Sinister ; Dark Beast

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: ALPHA

- **The prologue:** **David Haller** goes back in time to kill Magneto, and **Xavier dies** saving him.
- **The Age of Apocalypse.** North America is **Apocalypse's**. Humans are **culled**.
- **Magneto's X-Men, Rogue at his side.** A strange soldier, **Bishop**, keeps **talking about someone called "Xavier."**

ACT TWO: THE WAR

- **The X-Men split** into teams: **Weapon X** and **Jean** go to the **Human High Council**; **Nightcrawler** and **Blink** search for the **M'Kraan Crystal**; **Cyclops** turns against **Sinister**.
- **The Council's nuclear strike** is coming. **Humanity** and **mutants** both **run out of time**.

ACT THREE: OMEGA

- **Magneto vs. Apocalypse.** **Apocalypse** breaks Magneto's body, and **Magneto tears Apocalypse in half** (*Omega*).
 - **Bishop enters the Crystal**, to go back and **undo this world**. And inside, **there is no past**. **This world began less than two years ago**. **A masked face** looks back at him from **inside the Crystal: Doom's**.
 - **Bishop comes back.** **The nuclear strike** hits, and **Blink** saves who she can.
 - **Bishop tells Magneto the truth.** Magneto, beaten and bleeding, looks up at **the statue of Doom** on the horizon.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Battleworld: the Age of Apocalypse domain. Monday, May 7 → Saturday, August 25, 2029.
Where it's set	Battleworld: the Age of Apocalypse (Apocalypse's citadel, Wundagore, the Human High Council, the M'Kraan Crystal)
Relative to other films	It follows <i>Iron Man: Armor Wars</i> .

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- Apocalypse is dead. Magneto's X-Men know the truth about Battleworld.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Bishop's truth	He's seen what came before	<i>Avengers: Battleworld</i>

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Doom's face in the Crystal	Bishop's vision	Doom created everything, and the barons are waking up

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "FAMILY." Magneto and Rogue on a hill, with their son Charles asleep between them. Rogue: <i>"Was he a good man? The one we named him for?"</i> Magneto: <i>"The best I ever knew."</i>
Post-credit scene	✓ "BARONS." A secret meeting in the ruins beyond the Shield: Magneto, Baron Tony Stark of Technopolis, Logan of the Wastelands, and Sheriff Strange . STRANGE: <i>"I've known since the first day. I'm done lying for him."</i> CUT TO BLACK. "THE X-MEN WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " HILLTOP. " Post-credit: " ROUND TABLE II. "

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline